psychological and spiritual emptiness that has become an everyday experience for a vast multitude of people (which is partly why they sell their freedoms to authoritarian leaders just to get rid of their unbearable and crippling anxieties). Similarly, after years of an authoritarian and imperious leadership model, Rahul Gandhi may be consciously posing an alternative model of leadership to India and evoking *maanavnishtha Bharatiyata* (humane Indian nationalism), something Supriya Shrinate's article alludes to.

However, an unrelated but important unforeseen consequence of the BJY could have been that, in giving a vast plethora of India's constituent groups a constructive platform to air their grievances, it acted like a safety valve. This certainly connected them to the Congress party (and more specifically Rahul Gandhi), but it may have blunted the fervour that grievances can generate. While this may seem counterintuitive for a political party (which should have leveraged such grievances for electoral ends), history teaches us that defeating an authoritarian state that deploys all the governing instruments of the State against its opponents requires out-of-the-box thinking. Like the Indian freedom struggle did against the colonial state, methodical and consistent guerrilla tactics can chip away seemingly invulnerable foundations. And I suspect that Rahul Gandhi is methodically recapturing the margins and moving inwards.

But having said that, much more can be done to constructively mop up the energies that flowed into the Yatra and the party organization. In large part because of the manner in which Rahul Gandhi engaged with India, people's antipathies about the Congress party have ebbed. There is a pervasive feeling that the Congress remains the only political force that will not compromise with the BJP, which is why millions of Indians are psychologically realigning themselves with the values that it espouses. After almost twelve years of incessant propaganda by the BJP, the sight of the Yatra relentlessly grinding on week after week finally resignalled to India his and the Congress's steadfast commitment to the nation and the people.